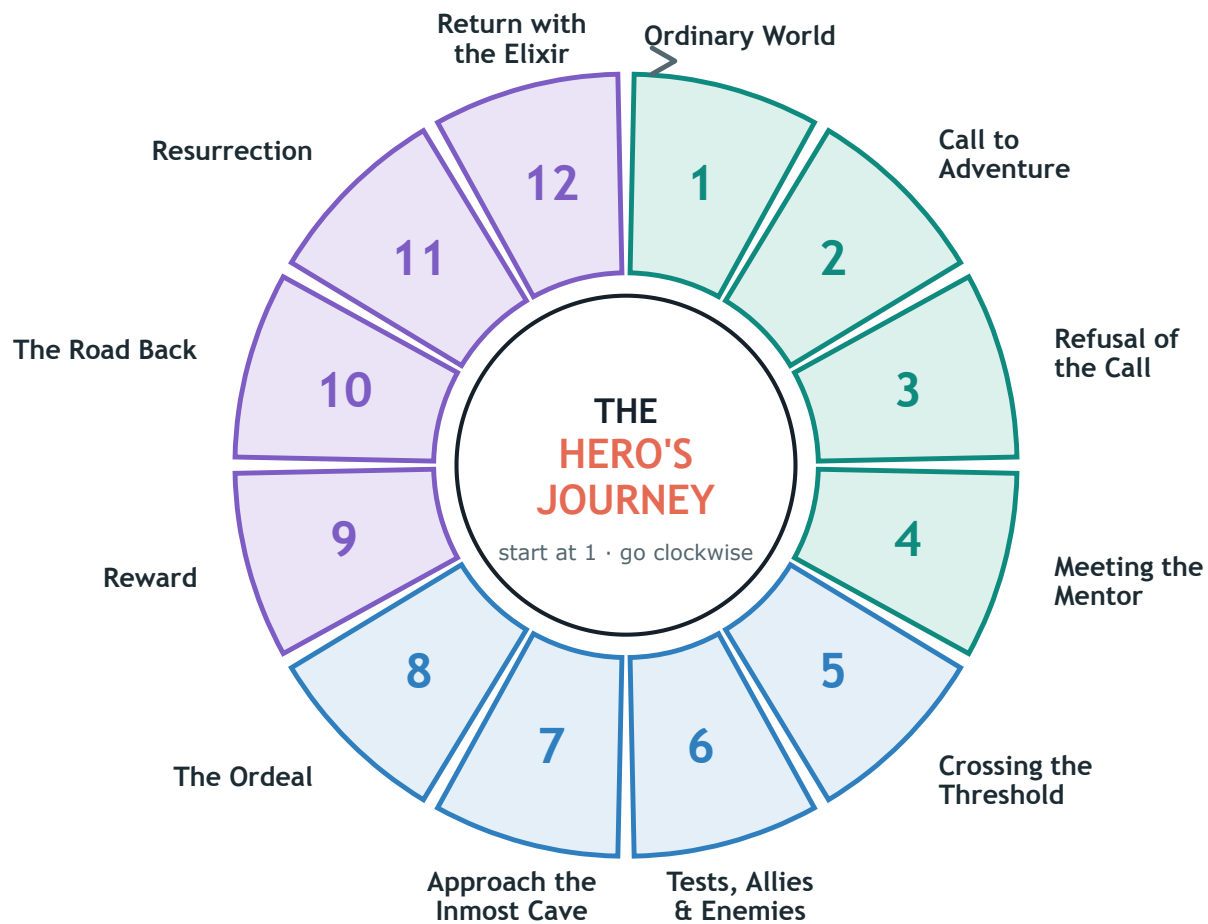


The Hero's Journey — 12 Steps Around the Circle

Every great story travels this wheel. Star Wars · Moana · Spider-Man · YOURS.

MON · 1-4 · Setup TUE · 5-8 · Adventure WED · 9-12 · Victory



TEAM: _____ COMIC: _____

The 12 Steps — Examples + Your Script

Each step: what it means · how Moana does it · what YOU say and ask. The ASK questions are the girls' planner-box prompts.

1

Ordinary World

Home. Normal life, before anything changes.

 **Moana:** Moana lives on Motunui — the chief's daughter, never allowed past the reef.

 **SAY:** "Every story starts at home." **ASK:** "What does your hero's normal day look like?"

2

Call to Adventure

Something happens that invites the hero out of her normal world.

 **Moana:** The island is dying — and the ocean chooses Moana, handing her the heart of Te Fiti.

 **SAY:** "Something knocks on the hero's door." **ASK:** "What problem shows up that only YOUR hero can solve?"

3

Refusal of the Call

Doubt and fear. The hero (or someone she loves) says 'no, stay.'



Moana: Her father forbids sailing past the reef; Moana tries to stay the good daughter.



SAY: "Real heroes hesitate — that's what makes them brave later." **ASK:** "What makes your hero afraid to start?"

4

Meeting the Mentor

A guide appears with wisdom, a gift, or a push.



Moana: Gramma Tala shows her the hidden cave of voyaging ancestors: "You know who you are."



SAY: "Every hero gets a guide." **ASK:** "Who believes in your hero before she believes in herself?"

5

Crossing the Threshold

The point of no return — she leaves home for the unknown.



Moana: Moana sails past the reef for the first time. The rules of home no longer apply.



SAY: "One step — and everything changes." **ASK:** "What door does your hero walk through that she can't walk back out of?"

6

Tests, Allies & Enemies

First battles, new friends, hard lessons.



Moana: She finds Maui (ally... eventually!), fights the Kakamora, learns to sail.



SAY: "The middle is where friends are made and skills are earned." **ASK:** "Who joins the team? What's the first fight?"

7

Approach the Inmost Cave

The big challenge is close. Nerves build. Plans are made.



Moana: Moana and Maui near Te Kā — the lowest moment: Maui leaves, and she almost gives up.



SAY: "Right before the biggest fight comes the biggest doubt." **ASK:** "What almost makes your hero quit?"

8

The Ordeal

The hardest fight — the villain seems to be winning.



Moana: Facing Te Kā alone — everything she's learned gets tested at once.



SAY: "This is the page your readers can't put down." **ASK:** "How do the heroes COMBINE their different powers here?"

9

Reward

What the hero gains from surviving — an object, a truth, or confidence.

 **Moana:** Moana knows exactly who she is now — a wayfinder — and she has the heart.

 **SAY:** “Winning the fight isn’t the prize — what she **LEARNS** is.” **ASK:** “What does your hero have now that she didn’t before?”

10

The Road Back

Heading home — but carrying something new.

 **Moana:** She sails back toward Te Fiti to restore the heart and finish the mission.

 **SAY:** “The journey home matters as much as the journey out.” **ASK:** “What still has to be finished?”

11

Resurrection

The final test. The hero's biggest change — and where the villain's lie falls.

 **Moana:** Moana sees the truth: Te Kā IS Te Fiti. She walks TOWARD the monster — “this is not who you are” — and restores the heart.

 **SAY:** “The villain's lie gets disproven right here, on the page.” **ASK:** “What stereotype falls — and HOW do your heroes prove it wrong?”

12

Return with the Elixir

Home, changed — sharing the gift with everyone.

 **Moana:** Moana returns a wayfinder and her whole people voyage again. The gift wasn't just for her.

 **SAY:** “A hero brings the win HOME.” **ASK:** “How does your hero lift her community at the end?”

Same wheel every time: Star Wars, Spider-Man, Encanto, Moana — and now THEIR comic. 